

JSS2 English Language Diagnostic Bank (Part 3)

Curriculum Scope: Cambridge Lower Secondary (Stage 8) & Nigerian JSS2 Core

Focus: Reading Comprehension, Inference, and Literary Analysis

Passage A: The Solar Innovation (Non-Fiction)

In the heart of a bustling Nigerian city, a group of young innovators recently unveiled a "Solar Kiosk." While many saw it as just a metal box, the creators viewed it as a lifeline for small businesses. These kiosks provide chilled storage for food and charging points for mobile devices, all powered by the relentless West African sun. The project aims to mitigate the frequent power outages that cripple local trade. By harvesting renewable energy, the youth are not only solving an economic problem but also addressing environmental concerns. It is a testament to the fact that local solutions can tackle global challenges.

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Diagnostic Purpose
41	What is the primary purpose of the "Solar Kiosk"? A) To store metal boxes B) To support small businesses during power outages C) To decorate the city D) To sell solar panels	B	Identifying Main Idea.
42	According to the passage, the West African sun is described as: A) Weak B) Relentless C) Dangerous D) Occasional	B	Literal Retrieval/Vocabulary.
43	The word " mitigate " as used in the passage means: A) To increase B) To ignore C) To lessen or reduce D) To hide	C	Contextual Meaning.
44	What environmental benefit is mentioned in the text? A) It creates jobs B) It uses renewable energy C) It cleans the streets D) It cools the air	B	Identifying Supporting Details.
45	Which statement best reflects the author's tone? A) Skeptical B) Critical C) Admiring/Positive D) Indifferent	C	Recognizing Tone/Attitude.

Passage B: The Unseen Echo (Modern Fiction)

Kofi sat by the edge of the lake, the silence of the evening heavy around him. He had expected the news for weeks, yet when the letter finally arrived, its weight felt like lead in his pocket. He didn't need to open it to know that the scholarship results were inside. A single ripple broke the surface of the green water—a small fish jumping for a fly. Kofi sighed, thinking of his father's worn-out boots and the long miles he had walked to keep Kofi in school. The sun dipped below the horizon, casting long, purple shadows that seemed to whisper of missed opportunities.

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Diagnostic Purpose
46	How does Kofi feel about the letter? A) Excited and joyful B) Apprehensive and heavy-hearted C) Angry and frustrated D) Bored	B	Inferring Character Emotion.
47	What does the phrase " weight felt like lead " suggest about the letter? A) It was made of metal B) It contained bad news or a heavy burden C) It was very thick D) It was expensive	B	Identifying Similes/Metaphorical Meaning.
48	Why does the author mention been "his father's worn-out boots"? A) To show his father needs new clothes B) To emphasize his father's hard work and sacrifice C) To describe the local fashion D) To explain why they are near a lake	B	Analyzing Literary Symbolism.
49	The setting of the story is most likely: A) Early morning B) Mid-day C) Sunset/Evening D) Night	C	Identifying Setting via Clues.
50	Kofi's reaction to the fish jumping suggests he is: A) Hungry B) Distracted C) Deep in thought D) Scared	C	Character analysis through behavior.

Cluster 3: Literary Devices & Summary Skills

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Diagnostic Purpose
51	"The wind whispered through the trees." This is an example of: A) Simile B) Metaphor C) Personification D) Hyperbole	C	Literary Devices (Figurative Language).
52	In a summary, you should always: A) Include every detail B) Use as many words as possible C) Focus on main points only D) Give your personal opinion	C	Summary Writing Principles.
53	Which of these is a "Fact" rather than an "Opinion"? A) Mathematics is the best subject. B) Nigeria is located in West Africa. C) The exam was very difficult. D) Rainy days are sad.	B	Fact vs. Opinion Distinguishing.
54	If a story is told from the perspective of "I," it is written in the: A) First person B) Second person C) Third person D) Omniscient	A	Point of View.
55	What is the "Climax" of a story? A) The beginning B) The turning point or highest tension C) The very end D) The introduction of characters	B	Structure of Narrative.
56	Which title would be best for Passage A? A) The Dangers of Heat B) Innovative Energy for Local Trade C) Young People in the City D) Metal Boxes of Nigeria	B	Creating Summarizing Titles.
57		B	Identifying Themes in Literature.

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Diagnostic Purpose
	Identify the "Theme" of Passage B: A) Fishing B) Sacrifice and Expectation C) Weather changes D) Postal services		
58	A comparison using "as" or "like" is a: A) Metaphor B) Simile C) Irony D) Onomatopoeia	B	Device identification.
59	Which of these is most likely a "Thesis Statement"? A) Once upon a time... B) In conclusion... C) This essay will argue that technology improves education. D) Hello everyone.	C	Writing Structure Knowledge.
60	Diagnostic Insight: Difficulty with Inference (Q46, Q48) indicates a student may struggle with literature analysis in JSS3.	-	Pathway alignment.